



Part—1

This article is about the open source work-flow automation software, ProcessMaker. It covers the basic set-up and how to get started with ProcessMaker. This should interest small and medium enterprises, start-ups or any other organisation in need of work-flow automation.

With a number of start-ups coming up these days, I suppose this is the era of dreams, and the courage to live those dreams. People have many ideas, and they are not afraid of executing these ideas. But a common problem faced by start-ups is to have a well-defined process flow for various activities—they often end up with either too many or too few processes, and as we know, neither is desired. This article explains how to use the open source software, ProcessMaker, to automate your office just as you want it, and that too, with total ease. Yes, this is the power of open source!

Setting things up

First, download ProcessMaker from the website (www.processmaker.com). It is a Web-based application, so it doesn't matter what server you're

using. The set-up comes for Windows (i.e., in .exe format) as well as for Linux machines. Naturally, here we will discuss the Linux edition. The set-up bundles all the software you'd need for ProcessMaker to run—the Apache Web server, MySQL and, of course, ProcessMaker itself, so you can just install the bundle instead of breaking your head over what more you need in order to support the application. There is a catch, though: port 80 of your server will now be used by this installed (bundled) Apache Web server; so it's better to remove any previous Apache installations, or if you know what you're doing, change the default listening port in the `httpd.conf` file.

Getting started

Once installed, just go to <http://localhost> and you will see the ProcessMaker login page. The default credentials are `admin, admin`. Don't forget to change